

have provided a near-final solution to one of our customer agents.

Q. Any plans to set up something like the government of India's DigiLocker?

A. There are many innovations going on, some of which are now production grade. We are investing heavily in using biometrics—be it your fingerprint or facial recognition—as your identity so as to enable travelling through an airport without having to show a single piece of paper including your passport. Our solutions are in the pilot stage at the Delhi, Hyderabad and Goa international airports.

There are innovations parallel to the DigiLocker that are happening. During the pandemic, almost all travellers were concerned if it was safe to travel through airports, what were the regulations prevalent in destination cities/areas, and how to find a healthcare network in case some testing was needed. So, Amadeus created a safe travel ecosystem for a traveller, a kind of a document repository system, creating a network of healthcare providers, government regulations and travel players, so that the traveller felt confident to come out and start travelling. It has seen significant uptake in the travel industry over the last two years, and multiple airlines are getting millions of documents processed on this platform.

Q. That brings me to the pandemic. How did you handle that period? And what was your message to your team during those tough days?

A. There is no beating around the bush there. It was a very, very tough time for the entire industry when, in March 2020, world travel almost came to a standstill. Because we run such a large travel platform for the industry, we have seen disruptions in different pockets or some regions. The SARS virus, bird flu, etc, had disrupted travelling in some

areas of the world in the past, but world travel still used to happen.

This was perhaps the first case where the entire travel ecosystem came to a standstill worldwide. It did impact our entire customer base. It impacted Amadeus significantly, with a sharp dip in our revenues worldwide, maybe the sharpest ever.

But there was a strong resolve in our executives and in the leadership that if this industry has to recover, it is the technology that is going to make a difference by creating a safe ecosystem that connects the players a lot better and thereby, brings the confidence back into the industry. And sure enough, that's exactly what happened. We knew that it was the technology that would keep the industry going. And that's one way we found to motivate our engineers to innovate. We still believe that the need for technology is almost the highest ever in the industry now.

I'm sure you're seeing that now travel has recovered almost to pre-pandemic levels, or even crossed that level in some areas. We are still continuing that impetus of innovation in the industry.

Q. What is your message to engineering students or even to those who are working professionally, about building a skillset in the open source space?

A. I would say this is an absolutely great time to be in the technology industry. Because 20 years back, open source was not as sophisticated and proprietary software was ruling the roost. I think we are now reaching a level of maturity in this industry where there is a balance between proprietary packaged software and open source. I believe the use of open source is growing at a double-digit CAGR of around 15-16% year-on-year.

This is the time to hone our skills and make sure that we stay relevant by participating in the open source wave that the world is in. And again,

companies like Amadeus, which run large technology centres, are responsible and take accountability to contribute back to this community that we are benefiting a lot from. So, we motivate our engineers to inner source that software so that other engineers within the company benefit from the technology that they developed, and collectively expose that to the travel industry and thereby contribute back.

Q. How do you recognise contributions by Amadeus engineers giving back to the community? Is there any kind of motivation, reward or recognition system?

A. We have a well-recognised rewards and recognition framework within the company. We have a patent wall in our offices where you will see all the IPs that have been generated by the engineers in our organisation. We showcase and promote that. And there is also financial remuneration that we provide to our engineers when they file a patent, or when they log a disclosure and knowhow. We have a central team that helps them create the paperwork for the patent, and so on. The open source contributions that our engineers make are also a part of that.

Q. Is there a data centre in India also? How are your data centres deployed across the globe?

A. Our primary data centre is in Germany, in the south of Munich, but now, we have declared that we are on a public cloud transformation within the company. We have partnered with Microsoft and at this point, the transformation is on. We are looking to increase the payload that we are reaching into Microsoft Azure, and now that the partnership is set and is in motion, eventually, the reach of the platform will be worldwide.

And while the initial data centres we are setting up are going to be in